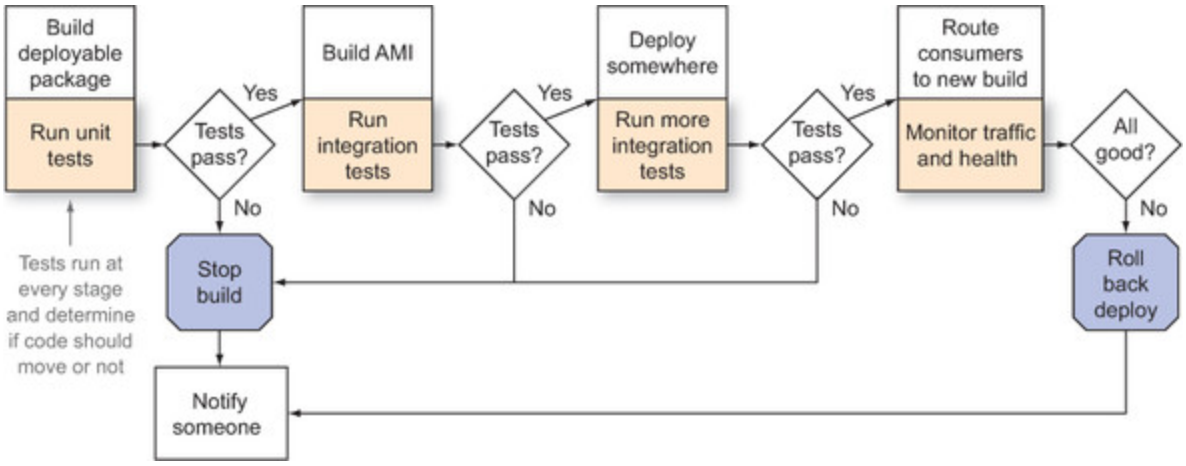


Figure 5.6 highlights the fact that every stage in the CD pipeline relies on automated tests (CT) to inform the decision on moving to the next stage in the deployment. If this data is rich enough to inform a decision on moving through the automated deployment process, it can also provide good insight into how your team is operating. A couple of things that this can help point to, especially when paired with VCS, are:

- ***Specific trouble spots in your code that are slowing you down*** —By identifying sections of your codebase that have significant technical debt, you can anticipate updating those sections to take longer than expected. You can use this information to adjust estimates or set expectations with stakeholders.
- ***Your team's commitment to automation*** —Having great automation is key to allowing your team to move faster and get changes out to consumers. Gauging this helps determine the potential delivery speed of your team.

Getting data from CT is as easy as tapping into the test results that are published in your CI system because the CI/CD system publishes and parses these results.

5.2. Preparing for analysis: generate the richest set of data you can